

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 2NT

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 6 4
♥ Q 10 4
♦ 9 6 5
♣ 10 7 5 2

♠ 9 8 3

♥ 7 3

♦ A K 4 2

♣ A K Q J



♠ A Q 10

♥ J 6 2

♦ Q J 10 8

♣ 9 6 4

♠ J 7 5 2

♥ A K 9 8 5

♦ 7 3

♣ 8 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
has is the ♥ A K.

In response to partner's Stayman bid you bid 2♦ to indicate no 4-card Major. Partner now bids 2♥.

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Partner's bid shows 5♥s, and by inference, 4♠s. Your hand does not provide an 8-card fit in either Major, so with 17 points you say 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♦Q.

Winner List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 4 :: Total = 8

You need one more winner and without question it must come from the ♥ suit.

Your problem is finding dummy entries, all dummy

You must find the ♥s split 3-3. You must also duck a ♥ to keep a valuable entry. Win the ♦ and play the ♥7, ducking in dummy.

West will win the ♥ and return a ♦ which you win in your hand. You now play your last ♥ to dummy, and if the suit was originally 3-3 you will win 4 ♥ tricks.

The "brute force" method for establishing dummy's ♥ suit would be to play ♥ A K, then another. If they split 3-3 your last two ♥s would be winners.

Of course you'd look pretty stupid to have those 2 ♥ winners in dummy and no way to reach them.

So you use the duck instead.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 9 8 7 5 2

♥ 6 5 2

♦ K

♣ 9 7 4

♠ 6 3

♥ 9 8 4

♦ A 8 6 4 3

♣ Q J 3



♠ K 10

♥ A K 7

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ A K 8 2

♠ A Q 4

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 10 7 2

♣ 10 6 5

With your 6-card Major suit you naturally use a transfer; bid 3♥. Partner responds 3♠.

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Partner has at least 20 points so you bid 4♠.

The contract would be 4♠ played by West.

East plays 4♠. South leads the ♥Q and North plays ♥4.

West

North

East

South

3♥

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

You win the first trick with your ♥A. By doing this you leave South in the dark about who holds the ♥K. If you had instead won with the ♥K South would have known you held both honors since North would have played the ♥A if he held it.

You have 2 losers to get rid of and the good news is that you can establish 2 ♦ winners pretty easily. So do you start pulling trumps now?

No, stay away from trumps for now. You might have to lose the lead twice in trumps, and the first time they get the lead they will play another ♥ and expose the loser in that suit. Then, the next time they get the lead they will take their ♥ winner. You need to get rid of that ♥ loser **BEFORE** you start on trumps.

Play a small ♦ to the ♦K. North will take this and play another ♥ to your ♥K. Play your ♦Q and discard dummy's ♥ loser. Now you might just as well ruff that ♥ in dummy, (with the ♠7 to be safe), and play trumps from that side. It turns out that South has both high trumps but you don't care because dummy's ♣ loser can be dumped on your ♦J.

The ♦A was a "fast" loser which you couldn't avoid. But the ♥ loser was a "slow" loser. Slow losers can sometimes be discarded, but you may have to do so before you lose the lead too many times.

Did you notice that if the opening lead had been a ♣ instead of a ♥ you would have used the same technique?

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 4

♥ Q 8 2

♦ Q 10

♣ K J 9 7

♠ J 5

♥ A K 7 4 3

♦ 8 4 3

♣ 6 3 2



♠ Q 7 6 2

♥ J 9 5

♦ K J 9 7

♣ Q 10

♠ A K 3

♥ 10 6

♦ A 6 5 2

♣ A 8 5 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♦

Pass

1NT

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by South

little to work with. In fact, the only real chance you have is to establish dummy's ♥ suit.

You must find the ♥s split 3-3. Even then, with no entries in dummy outside the ♥ suit you cannot afford to play ♥ A K followed by a third one. True, the suit would be established, but you could never get to it.

So you win the first trick with your ♠K, then play a ♥, ducking in dummy.

An opponent will win the ♥, but whatever they return you win one of your Aces. Then play your last ♥ to dummy. If the suit splits you will make 4 ♥ tricks to go with your 4 other top honors.

You were very lucky to find a 3-3 ♥ split. This happens only about 40% of the time.

But if you had not made the correct plan your good fortune would have been wasted.

Partner's 2♦ bid is a transfer so you bid 2♥. Partner now bids 2NT.

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Partner is describing an invitational hand (9-10 points) with a 5-card ♥ suit. With a bare 15 points and doubleton ♥ you just pass.

West leads the ♠10 against your 2NT.

You try dummy's ♠J hopefully, but East puts on the ♠Q.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

You must find two more winners. And you have very